

Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie
Chief Executive Officer: Ashish Bagga

Editor: Prabhu Chawla
Managing Editors: Raj Chengappa, Dilip Bobb, Shankkar Aiyar
Editor-at-Large: S. Prasannarajan, Executive Editor: Kaveree Bamzai
Deputy Editors: Farzand Ahmed, Damayanti Datta,
Ashok K. Damodaran, Sharda Ugra
Senior Editors: Saurabh Shukla, MUMBAI: Malini Bhupta,
HYDERABAD: Amarnath K. Menon
Photo Editor: Bhandeep Singh
Art Editor: Sapna Kapoor
Associate Editors: Bhavna Vij-Aurora, S. Sahaya Ranjit,
Priya Sahgal, Sandeep Unnithan, AHMEDABAD: Uday Mahurkar,
LUCKNOW: Subhash Mishra
Assistant Editors: Nivedita Mukherjee,
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: M.G. Radhakrishnan, KOLKATA: Elora Sen
Special Correspondents: Shafi Rahman, JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar,
BANGALORE: Nirmala Ravindran
Principal Correspondents: Mihir Srivastava, Nandini Vaish;
BANGALORE: Stephen David, Swagata Sen; BHOPAL: Ambresh Mishra,
MUMBAI: Jhimil Motihar, Aditi Patil; PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava
Copy Desk: Nardeep Singh Dahiya (Senior Editor), Anamika Chatterjee, Kaushik Deka, Rahul Kumar, Anika Mohla,
Sangram Keshari Parhi, Shilpi, Priyanka Sood, Shveta Srivastava,
Rahul Tewari, Priya Verma, Anju Yadav
Photo Department: Hemant Chawla, Sipra Das, Yasbanti Negi,
Ravi Sahani, Vikram Sharma, Reuben Singh,
AHMEDABAD: Shailesh Raval, CHENNAI: H.K. Rajasekar,
MUMBAI: Mandar Deodhar, Shriya Patil, Bhaskar Paul,
Rashmi Hajela (Chief Photo Researcher)
Infographics and Illustrations: Saurabh Singh
Art Department: Madhu Bhaskar (Art Director), Ranjita Bhattacharji,
Vandana Nayar, Jyoti K. Singh (Deputy Art Directors), Rasshi Ajmani
Girdhar, Vipin Gupta, Pushinder Kaur, Madhumangal Singh
Production Department: Surinder Hastu (Chief of Production),
Harish Aggarwal, Naveen Gupta

Publishing Director: Malcolm D. Mistry
Associate Publisher: Manoj Sharma (Impact)

IMPACT TEAM

Senior General Manager: Upendra Wellingkar (West and South)
General Managers: Kaustav Chatterjee (East), V. Somasundaram
(Chennai), Preeti Kohli (North), Jitendra Lal (West)
Deputy General Manager: Viswanath C.V. (Bangalore)

Consumer Marketing Services: Poonam Sangha,
Senior General Manager

Sales and Operations: Vivek Gaur, Executive Director
D.V.S. Rama Rao, Senior General Manager
Vinod Das, General Manager (Sales)
Deepak Bhatt, General Manager, Sales (North)
Rajesh Menon, General Manager, Sales (West)
M. Krishna Kiran, Deputy General Manager, Sales (South)
S. Sridhar, General Manager (Operations)



Volume XXXIV Number 24; For the week
June 9-15, 2009, released on June 8

• Editorial Office Living Media India Ltd. F-14/15, Connaught Place New Delhi 110001; Phones: 23315801-4; Fax: 23316180; Cable: Livmedia, New Delhi
• Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (UP)-201301; Phones: Toll-free number: 1800 1800 100 (from BSNL/MTNL lines); (95120) 2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad; (0120) 2479900 from Rest of India (Monday-Friday, 10 a.m.-6 p.m.); Fax: (0120) 4078080; e-mail: secare@intoday.com; Mumbai: 022-24444423-6; Fax: 24444356 • Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, 201 Competent House, F-14, Middle Circle, Connaught Place, New Delhi • Regd. Office: K-9 Connaught Circus, New Delhi 110001 • Impact Offices: Trade Centre, 2nd Floor, Kamala City, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai 400013; Phone: 24983355; Fax: 24982266 • Hamilton House, 1-A, Connaught Place, New Delhi 110001; Phone: 23352233; Fax: 2327330 • 99-A, Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai, 2nd Floor, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004; Phones: 28478526-41; Telex: 041-6177 Into In; Fax: 28472178; Cable: Livmedia Chennai • 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones: 22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; Cable: Livmedia, Bangalore • 52, Jawaharal Nehru Road, 4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; Cable: Livmedia, Kolkata • 6-3-885/7B, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23401010, 23402481, 23410982, 23411498; Fax: 23403484 • 39/1045, Karakkatt Road, Kochi 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058; Fax: 2377059 • 2/C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchewadi, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293 • Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited. Printed and published by Ashish Bagga on behalf of Living Media India Ltd. Printed at Thomson Press India Ltd., 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana); A-9, Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, district Kancheepuram-603209, (Tamil Nadu); and at Plot No. 5-5A, TTC Industrial Area, Thane, Belapur Road, Airoli, Navi Mumbai-400708, (Maharashtra). Published at K-9, Connaught Circus, New Delhi-110001. • INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

For reprint rights and syndication enquiries, contact
syndications@intoday.com or call +91-120-4078000
www.syndicationstoday.in

From the editor-in-chief

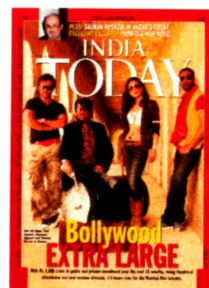
From Thank God it's Friday, it has become Oh God! It's Friday! Thanks to the stand-off between movie producers and multiplex owners, there has been no new movie released for the last two months, resulting in Bollywood's worst season in recent memory. Although the face-off may be resolved soon, for India's Rs 10,000-crore film business it has been a bruising 60 days. A host of big budget films, including some that feature international stars, are gathering dust while producers and theatre owners count their losses. Multiplexes have lost some Rs 250 crore while the loss suffered by producers is estimated at Rs 100 crore.

The hangover will last for some time. Bollywood, that fun place where the party never ended, has become a graveyard of expectations. That is equally to do with the financial meltdown which has affected the economics of Mumbai's hyperactive movie business. *Blue*, a deep sea thriller starring Akshay Kumar and produced for Rs 100 crore, has still to find a distributor. The untitled T-Series' film with Salman Khan, where they were paying him Rs 40 crore plus a percentage of profits, has been scrapped. So has Percept's *Come On Pappu*, a Rs 60-crore film starring Akshay Kumar. Even Karan Johar's Rs 88-crore *My Name is Khan* will struggle to get a price to cover its costs. Other examples abound and while it may not be The End, it certainly heralds a meaner, leaner Bollywood. Just two years ago, *Om Shanti Om* was sold for Rs 73 crore. Last year, *Ghajini* went for Rs 91 crore, excluding the music rights. Too few stars and too much public and institutional money made for bad economics.

The fundamentals of the movie business are shifting and this could well be Bollywood's big makeover. The confrontation between the producers and multiplex owners for an equal share of box office revenue has come at a time when the domestic box office has assumed immense importance for producers. Other sources of revenue are drying up. The global recession knocked 65 per cent off satellite rights, which used to contribute 30 per cent to overall film revenue. Music costs, sliding for years, have touched rock bottom, a 25 per cent fall. The overseas box office has dropped by 30 per cent. The crisis has got everyone rushing back to the drawing boards.

New projects have slowed down and old deals are being renegotiated. Reliance has dumped the special effects saga *Talisman*, starring Amitabh Bachchan while Eros is delaying its Saif Ali Khan caper *Agent Vinod*. There's just not enough money. The flip side is that a lot of producers are secretly delighted that the art of filmmaking is replacing the business of book-keeping, where stars were paid the earth, moon and well, the stars. Aamir Khan, for instance, was paid Rs 21 crore plus a share of the profits for the Rs 60-crore *Ghajini*, which is one-third of its budget. Akshay Kumar was pegging his fee even higher as were others on Bollywood's A-list. Even character actors were demanding a crore for bit roles.

The new economic reality, highlighted by the two-month strike, may not mean pack-up but it is a wake-up call. Executive Editor Kaveree Bamzai did a cover story last year titled 'Bollywood Extra Large' which was a story about the film industry on steroids. Says Bamzai, "These days it's more like Diet Bollywood." As the showbiz saying goes, 'the show must go on' even if the smile is wearing a bit thin these days.



OUR APRIL
2008 COVER

(Aroon Purie)